Wall-Monitor PC Setup

CENTRAL MONITORING · SAWO

Version 2 · 22 October 2026 · Chrome
For: the person setting up the office display PCs

What this guide does

The Central Monitoring dashboard is a website that runs on a company server inside the office network. A monitor cannot open a website by itself, so each wall monitor is connected to a **regular PC**. This guide sets up such a PC so that, every time it is switched on, it:

- opens the dashboard **full screen**, with no tabs, address bar or menus (this is called **kiosk mode**);
- shows it in **Display mode** (the wall-monitor view: no filters, tables scroll by themselves);
- keeps the data up to date by itself (every 30 seconds, and right after the PC wakes up).

Nothing on this PC can change data: the dashboard only **reads** from Odoo, through our server. A PC with two monitors needs one browser window per monitor; see section 8.

1. Before you start

You need	Why / where to get it
The **server address**	From IT, once the system is installed on the server. Example: `http://192.168.1.50` or `http://monitoring.sawo.local`. In this guide it is written as `http://SERVER-ADDRESS`: always replace it with the real address.
The PC is on the **office network**	The dashboard is only reachable inside the office.
Google Chrome installed	The display PCs use Chrome (see the note in section 3 on why not Edge). Download it from `google.com/chrome` if it is missing.
Windows **logs in automatically** after power-on	The dashboard starts when Windows has logged in. Ask IT to set up automatic log-in for this PC (or log in by hand each morning).

2. Check that the address works

1. On the display PC, open Chrome normally.
2. Type the server address in the address bar and press `Enter`.
3. You should see the dashboard with the **Central Monitoring** header and a green **Connected to Odoo** badge.
4. Close the browser completely (all windows).

If the page does not open, the PC cannot reach the server: ask IT before continuing.

3. Create the start-up shortcut

A shortcut with special settings starts Chrome in full screen (kiosk mode).

1. Right-click an empty place on the desktop → **New** → **Shortcut**.
2. In **"Type the location of the item"**, paste this (one line), with the real server address:

   ```
   "C:\Program Files\Google\Chrome\Application\chrome.exe" --kiosk --no-first-run http://SERVER-ADDRESS
   ```

3. Click **Next**, name it **Central Monitoring**, click **Finish**.

What the parts mean: the first part (in quotes) is where Chrome is installed; `--kiosk` = full screen, no tabs, address bar or menus, and it cannot be left with `Esc`; `--no-first-run` = skip Chrome's welcome pages; the last part is the page to open.

If Chrome is installed somewhere else, right-click a Chrome icon → **Properties** and copy the path shown in **Target** (keep the quotes).

> **Why Chrome and not Edge:** Edge's kiosk mode (`msedge --kiosk`) always runs as a private (InPrivate) window and forgets everything when it closes, including Display mode. After every restart the screen would show the normal view with filters instead of the wall-monitor view. Tested on 22 October 2026: Edge kiosk forgot Display mode, Chrome kiosk remembered it.

If Chrome is already open when you double-click the shortcut, it may just open a normal window. Always close all Chrome windows first. On a dedicated display PC nothing else should be open.

4. Turn on Display mode (once per PC)

1. Double-click the new **Central Monitoring** shortcut. The dashboard opens full screen.
2. Click the **menu button** at the far left of the header (left of the SAWO logo). The side menu opens.
3. Under **Display**, tick **Display mode**. The filters disappear from the tables.
4. Click the **menu button** again to hide the side menu.

The PC remembers this from now on, also after a restart. It must be done **inside the window opened by the shortcut** (not in a normal browser window), because the setting is saved per browser.

5. Start automatically when the PC turns on

1. Press `Windows` + `R`, type `shell:startup` and press `Enter`. A folder opens.
2. Copy the **Central Monitoring** shortcut from the desktop into this folder.
3. Restart the PC to test: after Windows logs in, the dashboard should open full screen in Display mode by itself.

6. Power settings

Open **Settings** → **System** → **Power** (Windows 11; on Windows 10: **Settings** → **System** → **Power & sleep**):

- **Put my device to sleep after**: **Never** (recommended, so the data stays live).
- **Turn off my screen after**: anything you like. Staff may also simply switch the monitor off at night.

Switching only the **monitor** off is always fine: the PC keeps running and the data keeps updating. If the PC does go to sleep, the dashboard loads fresh data a few seconds after it wakes up.

7. Daily use and troubleshooting

Situation	What to do
Close the dashboard	Press <kbd>Alt</kbd> + <kbd>F4</kbd>.
Open it again	Double-click the **Central Monitoring** shortcut on the desktop.
Header shows **"Backend unreachable"** (red)	The PC cannot reach the server (network or server down). The screen keeps the last data and retries by itself every few seconds. If it lasts, tell IT.
Header shows **"Odoo update delayed"** (amber)	Nothing to do: the server will try again by itself. The numbers shown are the latest ones; see the **Last sync** time.
Header shows **"Data may be outdated"** (red)	Odoo has not been read for a while. Check the **Last sync** time and tell IT if it does not recover.
Filters are visible again after a restart	Display mode was turned off or not saved: repeat section 4 in the shortcut's window. Check that the shortcut starts **Chrome**, not Edge (section 3).
A yellow **"Filtered by: ..."** line is shown	The tables show only part of the orders. To remove it: open the menu, untick Display mode, clear the filter, tick Display mode again.
Text is too small or too big	Change the Windows display scaling: **Settings** → **System** → **Display** → **Scale** (for example 150% on a 4K monitor). The dashboard adapts by itself.
A browser pop-up appears (e.g. "Restore pages?")	Close it with the ×. It can appear once after the PC was switched off without shutting down.

8. PC with two (or more) monitors

Kiosk mode opens one full-screen window on the main monitor. For a second monitor:

- The simplest and most reliable setup is **one PC per monitor**, each set up with this guide.
- With one PC for two monitors, make a **second shortcut** for the second screen. It needs its own Chrome data folder (otherwise Chrome only opens one kiosk window) and the position of the second monitor:

  ```
  "C:\Program Files\Google\Chrome\Application\chrome.exe" --kiosk --no-first-run --user-data-dir=C:\ChromeKiosk2 --window-position=1920,0 http://SERVER-ADDRESS
  ```

  `1920,0` means "start 1920 pixels to the right", i.e. a second Full HD monitor placed to the right of the first. Adjust it to the width of the first monitor. Put both shortcuts in `shell:startup` and tick Display mode in **each** window (section 4). This setup was not tested on real monitors: check it after a restart.

Each window works on its own: its own size, its own data loading and its own settings.

Summary

> **Per display PC, once:** check the address (2) → create the Chrome `--kiosk` shortcut (3) → open it and tick Display mode (4) → copy the shortcut to `shell:startup` (5) → set sleep to Never (6).

Central Monitoring · Wall-monitor PC setup · Read-only dashboard: Odoo is never changed from these PCs. Replace `http://SERVER-ADDRESS` with the address given by IT.